Northstar Technologies — Employee Leave Policy

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1. Purpose

This policy establishes the procedures and general requirements for requesting, approving, recording, and managing employee leave at Northstar Technologies.

The policy supports employees' health, well-being, and work-life balance while helping teams maintain appropriate business coverage.

It applies to employees of Northstar Technologies, subject to their employment terms, applicable benefit plans, and the laws governing their employment location.

2. Types of Leave

Northstar Technologies recognizes several categories of leave. Eligibility, duration, compensation, and documentation requirements depend on the applicable policy and legal requirements.

Common leave categories include:

- Vacation leave.
- Sick leave.
- Personal leave.
- Parental and family-related leave.
- Bereavement leave.
- Public holidays and other legally required absences.
- Other approved leave arrangements.

Not every category is available under identical conditions to every employee. Employees should contact Human Resources to confirm their eligibility and applicable requirements.

3. Vacation Leave

Eligible employees may request vacation leave for rest, personal activities, and planned time away from work.

Vacation requests should be submitted through the approved leave management system before the intended absence.

Employees should provide their requested dates and any information required for scheduling and business continuity.

Managers review requests based on available leave balances, team coverage, operational priorities, and other relevant circumstances.

Employees should obtain approval before making nonrefundable personal travel arrangements that depend on the requested vacation dates.

Managers should communicate approval or rejection promptly and explain any scheduling constraints when a request cannot be accommodated.

4. Sick Leave

Employees who are unable to work because of illness or a medical condition must notify their manager as soon as reasonably possible.

When advance notice is impractical, employees should provide notification as soon as their circumstances permit.

Employees must follow the applicable procedure for recording sick leave and submitting any required supporting documentation.

Medical documentation may be requested when permitted or required by applicable law and company procedures.

Employees are not expected to disclose unnecessary medical details to their manager. Medical information must be handled confidentially and shared only with authorized individuals who need it for legitimate administrative purposes.

Employees returning from an extended illness may be asked to follow applicable fitness-for-work or return-to-work procedures, subject to legal requirements.

5. Personal Leave

Employees may request personal leave for significant personal matters that require time away from work.

Requests should be submitted to the manager through the approved leave process, explaining the requested dates and providing the information necessary to evaluate the request.

Approval depends on the type of leave, the employee's eligibility, applicable legal requirements, and operational considerations.

Employees should notify their manager as early as practical when an unexpected personal matter affects their availability.

The company may require supporting documentation for specific categories of personal leave when permitted by law and established procedures.

6. Parental and Family-Related Leave

Eligible employees may request parental leave and other family-related leave in accordance with company policies and applicable law.

Employees should contact Human Resources to understand eligibility, expected duration, documentation requirements, compensation arrangements, and the process for requesting leave.

Where possible, employees should notify Human Resources and their manager in advance so the team can plan for the absence.

The company will administer protected leave and related employment rights in accordance with applicable legal requirements.

Information concerning pregnancy, family circumstances, medical conditions, or other sensitive personal matters must be handled confidentially.

7. Bereavement Leave

Eligible employees may request bereavement leave following the death of a qualifying family member or another person covered by the applicable policy or law.

Employees should notify their manager or Human Resources as soon as reasonably possible.

The duration, compensation, eligibility, and documentation requirements depend on the applicable company rules and legal requirements.

Managers should handle these requests with sensitivity and refer employees to Human Resources when clarification is needed.

8. Public Holidays

Employees are entitled to applicable public holidays in accordance with their work location and employment arrangements.

Human Resources or the appropriate administrative team communicates the relevant holiday calendar.

Employees whose roles require work on a public holiday must follow the applicable scheduling, compensation, and approval procedures.

Public holiday entitlements and alternative arrangements are governed by applicable law and company procedures.

9. Leave Requests and Approval

Employees must use the designated leave management system or another approved method to submit leave requests.

A request should include:

- The leave category.
- The requested start and end dates.
- The expected return-to-work date, when known.
- Supporting information required for the specific leave category.

Managers are responsible for reviewing requests promptly and confirming the decision to the employee.

Employees must not assume that a request has been approved simply because it has been submitted.

If an absence is unexpected, the employee must follow the notification procedure for the relevant leave category and complete the formal recording process when practical.

Human Resources may review requests that involve protected leave, unusual circumstances, eligibility questions, or additional documentation.

10. Leave Balances and Records

Employees should review their available leave balances through the approved system and report discrepancies to Human Resources.

Leave balances, accruals, carryover limits, expiration rules, and payment of unused leave are determined by the applicable plan, employment terms, company policies, and local law.

Employees must record leave accurately. Managers should ensure that approved absences are reflected correctly in team schedules and administrative records.

Human Resources maintains leave records according to company procedures, privacy requirements, and applicable retention rules.

11. Extended Leave and Return to Work

Employees anticipating an extended absence should coordinate with Human Resources and their manager to understand the applicable procedures.

Depending on the leave category, the company may need to arrange temporary coverage, adjust responsibilities, or establish a return-to-work plan.

Employees should communicate any relevant changes to their expected return date as soon as reasonably possible.

Before returning from certain extended absences, employees may need to complete administrative steps or provide documentation where permitted or required by applicable law.

The company will handle return-to-work arrangements in accordance with applicable employment protections and accommodation requirements.

12. Responsibilities

Employees are responsible for submitting leave requests accurately, providing timely notifications, following applicable procedures, and recording absences correctly.

Managers are responsible for reviewing requests promptly, maintaining appropriate team coverage, communicating decisions, and respecting employee confidentiality.

Human Resources is responsible for explaining leave eligibility, maintaining appropriate records, administering relevant policies, and advising on legal or procedural requirements.

All individuals involved in leave administration must protect confidential information and comply with applicable company policies.

13. Unplanned Absences

When an employee cannot attend work because of an unexpected illness, emergency, or other urgent circumstance, the employee must notify their manager as soon as reasonably possible.

If the manager is unavailable, the employee should use the designated alternative notification channel.

The employee must provide an update when the expected duration of the absence changes significantly.

Repeated failure to follow notification or recording procedures may require review, subject to the circumstances and applicable legal protections.

Nothing in this section removes rights to protected leave or emergency-related absences established by applicable law.

14. Policy Compliance

Employees must use leave benefits for their intended purposes and provide accurate information when requesting or recording leave.

Misrepresentation, falsification of records, or deliberate misuse of leave may result in corrective action in accordance with company procedures and applicable law.

Questions about eligibility, documentation, or unusual circumstances should be directed to Human Resources.

15. Review and Updates

Human Resources is responsible for reviewing this policy periodically and updating it when company practices, benefit arrangements, or applicable legal requirements change.

Where a specific leave entitlement is governed by law or a separate approved benefit plan, the applicable legal or plan requirements take precedence over this general policy.

Employees should consult the current approved version and contact Human Resources when clarification is needed.

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